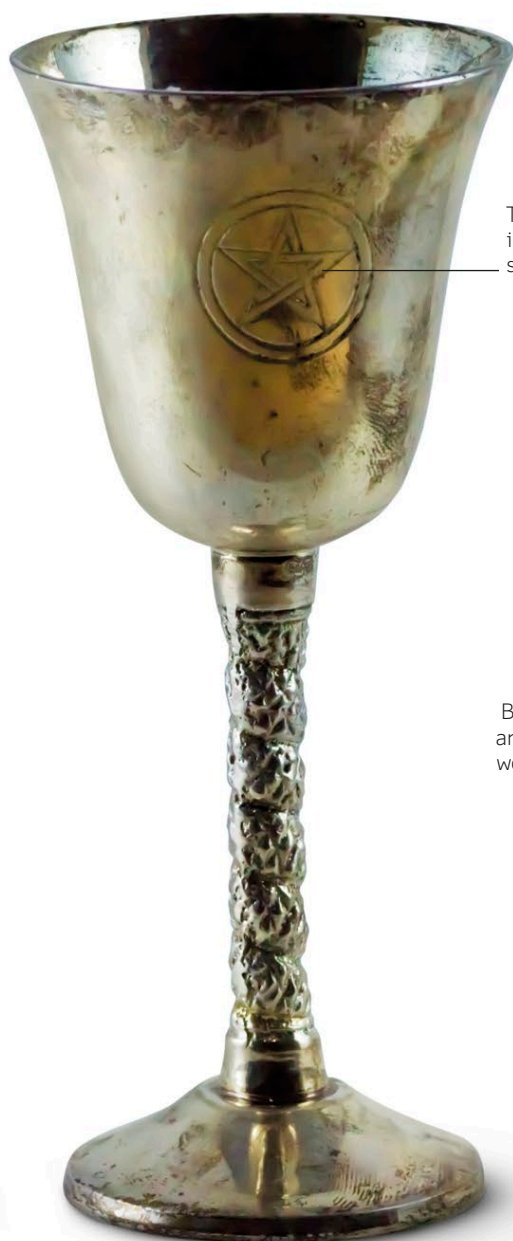


Wiccan tools

Special magical tools were first listed by the English Wiccan Gerald Gardner. Wiccan branches today select the tools that work for them, usually for altar rituals inside a magic circle to intensify spiritual (or “psychic”) energy and help achieve a direct connection with the divine. This connection gives the tools a divine power, which is shared with their user during magical rituals.



The pentacle is a Wiccan symbol



Both moon and sun are worshipped in Wicca

The handle is curved in a suggestion of antlers



The handle is a deer's hoof

▲ **Ritual scourges** are used only in some strands of Wicca as a symbol of the sacrifice and suffering initiates must undergo in order to learn more about witchcraft.



▲ **Athames (ritual knives)** are associated with the spirit of fire or air. They are used to cast a magic circle and direct energy inside it, never to draw blood.

▲ **Chalices** represent the Wiccan Goddess's womb and are filled with water, wine, ale, or herbal infusions depending on the ritual.

▲ **Bells** are mostly used by Wiccans to focus attention or attract energy. According to Gardner, each ritual called for a specific number of knells.



Deer antlers are sacred for Wiccans

▲ **Stangs (horned staffs)** are topped with antlers that represent the Wiccan Horned God. A stang can be used as a simple altar when traveling to help the journeying spirit.

The staff is made from a branch



▲ **Besoms (brooms)** have been linked to witches, who were said to fly on them, for so long that some Wiccans now see these tools as a cliché. Others connect besoms with sexual rituals, and couples may jump over a broom in the handfasting ceremony that equates to a wedding.